

Leave questions	
Am I Eligible for FMLA?	In general, if you have been employed for at least one year and have worked at least 1,250 during the previous 12 months you will be eligible for FMLA. Human Resources will confirm your eligibility for FMLA.
Why do I need to apply for FMLA?	The FMLA is a federal law and requires WCU to process all qualifying absences as FMLA.
Do I get additional paid leave under the FMLA?	No, you will only be paid if you have applicable paid leave balances to apply to your absences.
What if I am not eligible for FMLA?	There may be other leave options available. To confidentially discuss your situation, contact HR Leave Manager.
What documentation do I need when I am absent from work?	For any sick or sick family absence of 3 or more consecutive days, a doctor's note is required. That should be submitted to Payroll@wcupa.edu and to your supervisor. No private medical information should be included on the note; only the absence dates need to be listed. For any absence of 11 or more consecutive days, the FMLA paperwork must be submitted. Contact the Leave Manager for more information and the required paperwork.
What medical information is shared regarding my need for leave?	No medical information is shared outside to HR. You do not need to provide any private medical information to your supervisors.
How much time off can I take under the FMLA?	Usually this is determined by your medical provider, except in the case of parental leave.
My wife is having a baby. Can I take paid sick leave (or other paid leave)?	Sick leave can only be used when medically necessary.
I am having a baby. How much time off can I take?	This depends on your FMLA eligibility, but in general, employees can take at least 12 weeks of leave.
Will I get holiday pay while I am on a leave of absence?	As long as you are in paid status the afternoon before and the morning after the holiday, you will receive paid holiday leave.
I have an Optum debit card for my FSA, can I get one for my spouse?	Yes, if you are an OPTUM FSA you can obtain a second card for a spouse. Just call OPTUM at 1-833-325-9998
How do I submit charges for FSA expenses?	
How long do have to submit charges to my FSA?	If you are an OPTUM FSA member you can submit charges incurred in any given calendar year up until March 31st of the following calendar year.
Will my accrued time (vac,sick,personal) carryover from one year to the next?	In general, if you have been employed for at least one year and have worked at least 1,250 during the previous 12 months you will be eligible for FMLA. Human Resources will confirm your eligibility for FMLA.
How can I check my leave time balances?	Log into ESS/FIORI: https://portal.passhe.edu/ijr/portal
How can I find a list of participating physicians under my health plan?	Your medical provider (Aetna or Highmark) has an online physician directory on their webpage. If you are a Highmark member please go to: https://www.highmark.com/member/member-guide You will need to sign into your account. If you have never created an account before you will need to register. Once registered you can go to the Find a Doctor section and search for participating providers. You can also call Highmark Customer Service to find participant provider. This number can be found on the back of your Highmark ID card. If you are an Aetna member you can go to the Aetna web page at: https://www.aetna.com/ and log in. If you have never registered on the Aetna you will need to register by selecting Create My Account feature. Once you have done this you can access the physician directories for your specific Aetna plan. You can also obtain assistance finding network providers by calling Aetna Customer Service. This number can be found on the back of your Aetna ID card.
I have lost my healthcare ID card. How do I get a replacement?	Your medical provider (Aetna or Highmark) is where you print out a new ID card or request a new one. If you are a Highmark member please go to: https://www.highmark.com/member/member-guide You will need to sign into your account. If you have never created an account before you will need to register. Once registered you can click the View ID Card button. Here you can print a temporary card as well as order a new ID card. If you are an Aetna member you can go to the Aetna web page at: https://www.aetna.com/ and log in. If you have never registered on the Aetna you will need to register by selecting Create My Account feature. Once you have done this you can print out a temporary ID card and order a new one be sent to your home
I would like to access the free counseling services the university offers. How to I go about doing this?	These service are available under your State Employees Assistance Program (SEAP). OPTUM administers this benefit. You can access these benefits by calling 1-800-692-7459 or 1-800-824-4306 TDD. This line is available 24 hours a day. You can also obtain SEAP benefit information by going to www.liveandworkwell.com using access code Pennsylvania.
How many free counseling sessions do I get per year with the Employee Assistance Program?	Up to six face to face sessions for you (and each family member who accesses SEAP) with a SEAP counselor for each issue or problem. This benefit renews each calendar year.
Can I use the Dependent Care Account for summer camp?	
Is massage covered under my FSA?	Massage treatment for specific ailment or diagnosis may be eligible with a letter of medical necessity form completed. OPTUM will review on individual basis.
Where can I find a list of things eligible for reimbursement under my FSA?	A listing of items eligible for reimbursement under you FSA plan can be found in the FSA Handbook. Use this link to access the handbook: https://www.passhe.edu/hr/benefits/documents/fsa/2026-fsa-handbook.pdf
What is the maximum amount I am able to contribute to my Healthcare FSA?	The maximum contribution for 2026 is \$3300. The maximum can change each calendar year. Maximum for the upcoming calendar year is announced at annual Open Enrollment.
What is the maximum amount I can rollover to the new calendar year under the Healthcare FSA?	The rollover maximum for Healthcare FSA from 2026 to 2027 is \$660. Any amount remaining in your account after the runout period has ended is forfeited.
Do my dependents need to be enrolled in my healthcare coverage in order for me to submit their out of pocket expenses under my FSA?	Dependents do not need to be enrolled in your healthcare coverage in order to submit their out of pocket expenses under your Healthcare FSA.
Can any of my Dependent Care FSA funds roll over into the new calendar year?	No - under the Dependent Care FSA expenses must used in the calendar year where they are contributed.
Do I have to make a new Flexible Spending election each year?	Yes, a new election must be made each year for continued enrollment in the Flexible Spending Accounts. The fall Open Enrollment will allow you to make a new election for the upcoming calendar year.
Can I change the amount I am contributing to my FSA?	Changes during the calendar year can only be made if you have a qualifying life event. Some examples of this can be marriage, divorce or birth of a child. To determine if a life event qualifies you to make a mid-year change to either your Healthcare Flexible Spending Account or Daycare Flexible Spending Account please reach out to Benefits@wcupa.edu .
I am getting married this year. What is the process for adding my new spouse to my healthcare coverage?	
Am I eligible for any type of tuition assistance at schools other than WCU?	The answer to this question is different depending what employee group you are in. You can check the specifics for your employee group (or union) by going to the Tuition Waiver page in the following link: https://www.wcupa.edu/hr/tuition-waiver.aspx
Are books covered under the Tuition Waiver policy?	No - books are not a covered expense under Tuition Waiver.
If I leave the University, when do my healthcare benefits end?	Healthcare benefits end at midnight on your last day of employment.
How do I know if I am vested in my retirement plan?	
Can I change my retirement election?	No - retirement benefit elections need to made within 30 days of your retirement benefit eligibility date. (very often your hire date) Retirement elections are a permanent election. There is no Open Enrollment for retirement benefits.
How to I change my investments under my Fidelity/TIAA account?	You can go right to the Fidelity or TIAA web pages to make any changes to your investment selections. This applies to the Alternative Retirement Plan (ARP) as well as the 403b (Tax Sheltered Annuity) Fidelity participants go to www.fidelity.com - TIAA members go to www.tiaa.org
I need some financial guidance on the investments in my ARP retirement account. Is this something I can get help with?	On the PASSHE Retirement page under ARP you can see a button to click to "Meet with Fidelity" or "Meet with TIAA. Here is where you can schedule a one on one meeting with a representative and discuss your investment options. Visit the following link: https://www.passhe.edu/hr/benefits/retirement/arp.html
Where do I find a list of the investment choices in my Fidelity/TIAA account?	On the PASSHE Retirement page under ARP you will see a section on Investment Options. Here you will find the ARP Retirement Guide. This document is a listing of the investment option under both Fidelity and TIAA.
How much am I required to contribute to retirement?	

When am I vested in my retirement plan?	
Where can I find my balances for leave time?	Leave balances (annual, sick, personal and comp time) can be found in FIORI. You will need to sign into the Self Service Portal and choose the FIORI tab. Once in FIOR go to the Leave and Time section and choose the My Leave Request tile. You can see all your balances here. This is also where you can initiate a leave request.
How do I accrue vacation and sicktime?	
Can I anticipate future vacation or sicktime?	
When do I use Civil Leave?	Civil leave may be used when you are:
	Required to attend jury duty (not volunteer jury duty)
	Subpoenaed as a witness (NOT as a party) in a civil or criminal court proceeding
	Subpoenaed as a witness for any administrative hearings: worker's compensation, unemployment compensation, State Civil Service Commission, PA Human Relations Commission, State Employees' Retirement System or State Ethics Commission. However, if you are a party in any of these hearings, you may not use Civil Leave
	Civil leave may also be granted to employees who perform duties related to:
	Firefighting duties
	Emergency Medical Technician
	Civil Air Patrol duties
	Emergency management rescue work during a fire, flood, hurricane or other disaster
	Disaster relief work as a Certified Red Cross volunteer during a state of emergency as declared by the governor
	Note: in the absence of a flood, fire, hurricane or other disaster, Civil Leave cannot be granted. Example is a firefighter called to a traffic accident where there is no fire.
What documentation is required?	You must provide official documentation of any dates you were required to absent from your regularly scheduled work hours. That should be sent to Payroll@wcupa.edu and to your supervisor.
How do I request and use Civil Leave?	You should submit any absences in ESS/FIORI, selecting "Civil Leave" from the dropdown menu.
Will I receive my regular pay while on civil leave?	In general, yes, you will receive your regular pay for civil leave absences, but there are some exceptions:
	Compensation, with the exception of travel expenses, received for any witness testimony (not jury duty) must be relinquished to the University.
	An employee who receives compensation for jury duty, is not required to return the money to the University.
	Firefighters who are compensated by the Federal government for firefighting duties, must relinquish that payment to the University. If the money is not relinquished, the employee must be placed on an unpaid/regular absence with benefits.
Where can I find information on services that have been paid under my healthcare plan?	
Are vaccines covered under my healthcare plan?	
Are weight loss injections covered under my prescription plan?	
My spouse has an HSA with his employer, am I allowed to participate in the FSA?	
What type of retirement plans are offered?	All permanent full-time and part time employees are required to enroll in a group retirement plan. These plans have fixed contributions rates which can not be increased or decreased. The different retirement plan election options are SERS (State Employees Retirement System) and ARP (Alternative Retirement Plan)
	Retirement Plans PA State System of Higher Education
Can I increase or decrease my retirement contributions?	Group mandatory retirement contributions can not be increased or decreased as those rates are fixed.
How can I maximize my retirement savings?	Employees who wish to contribute more to retirement the State Systm offers two additional voluntary options to save and invest for retirement. Employees can choose to contribute up to the IRS limits on both plans.
	Tax-Sheltered Annuity (TSA) 403
	Deferred Compensation 457(b) Plan
Can I contribute to retirement if I am not benefits eligible?	Yes, if you are not eligible to enroll in the group retirement plan, the voluntary retirement plans are available to all employees upon their date of hire. These plans are employee contribution only.
	Tax-Sheltered Annuity (TSA) 403b
	Deferred Compensation 457(b) Plan